Jerry Davis

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SUMMARY

Gameplay Engineer and Game Designer with 4 years of professional programming experience, including 2+ years of game systems design and indie studio leadership for a dungeon-running title. Managed high-concurrency codebase for 4.5M users, directed interdisciplinary teams through the full dev-lifecycle, and shipped commercial systems design expansion for Dungeons & Dragons.

EXPERIENCE

Lead Game Developer & Founder
Silverwind Workshop
February 2022 – Current

- **Production Leadership:** Directing a 5-person interdisciplinary team to develop a systems-driven dungeon crawler focused on player invention and evolving customizable weapon-smithing trees via Agile/SCRUM. Managing asset pipelines and technical direction for art and audio integration.
- **Engineering:** Engineered a comprehensive controller suite for players and NPCs/enemies utilizing animation and AI state-machine logic with a focus on data-driven design. Programmed all combat logic.
- **Systems Design:** Designed systems for weapon progression, weapon evolution, photography, invention, and dungeon-crawling. Designed primary and secondary gameplay loops, and user interface.
- **Commercial Release:** Shipped positively reviewed digital Dungeons & Dragons game addon that replaced the rigid class system of the base game with 29 innovative skill trees while adding 160+ unique new assets (65 spells, 19 weapon types, 77 craft-able items, and 7 example characters). Interactive Demo and Design Intent Breakdown available in portfolio.

Senior Associate Developer
BlueShield of California via Infosys
March 2021 – March 2023

- **Engineering Leadership & Mentorship:** Led a team of 5 agile software engineers while providing Knowledge Transfers for Portal Support Team, Urgent Solutions Team, and Junior Associates.
- **Performance & Optimization:** Reduced web application overhead for 50% of pages through code profiling and optimization of pre-existing legacy code.
- **Reliable & Scalable Engineering:** Developed, bug-fixed, and performed code analysis of high-concurrency codebase used by 1 in 9 Californians.

PROJECTS

Mighty Morphin' Motorcat – Game Maker's Toolkit (GMTK) Game Jam 2024 "Built to Scale"

- **Lead Development & Management:** Led team of 4 interdisciplinary Unity developers using industry standard SCRUM methodology via daily stand-ups.
- **Game Systems Design & Engineering:** Designed puzzle racing primary gameplay loop, growing/shrinking mechanics, four types of puzzle obstacles, and user interface; Programmed player movement, growing, shrinking, success/failure mechanics, helicopter stop light, user interface, game state management, and particle effects.

Black Friday – GameDevTV Game Jam 2024 "Last Stand"

- **Lead Development & Management:** Led team of 6 interdisciplinary Unity developers using industry standard SCRUM methodology via daily stand-ups.
- **Game Systems Design & Engineering:** Designed tower defense primary gameplay loop, map layout, and theme; Programmed turret store, turret building, turret abilities, and user interface. Assisted in programming and bug-fixing character movement and melee attack.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's of Computer Science
Arkansas State University
August 2016 – May 2020

- Graduated with Cum Laude.

SKILLS

Hard Skills: C++, C#, JavaScript, Java, Python, Unity (Advanced), Unreal (Familiar), Blueprints (Familiar) Gamemaker, Git, Jira, MS Azure, Trello, Agile, Scrum, Systems Design, Game Design, State Management, Data Persistence, Problem Solving, Debugging, CI/CD, prototyping
Soft Skills: Cross-Discipline Integration, Communication, Leadership, Time Management, Teamwork, Critical Thinking